Don’t Choose a Mirror as Your Partner

When choosing a partner, don't look for someone just like you. **"A partner should not be your carbon copy."**

If you are great at marketing and your partner is also great at marketing, your ideas will constantly clash, often leading to conflict. A good partner should be someone who can fill the gaps in your own weaknesses.

- If you are a **visionary** and a **great salesperson**,
- Your partner should be **organized** and **skilled with data and finances.**

Just as a clear image emerges from the contrast of black and white, a partnership becomes stronger when people with different skills combine their strengths. Before looking for a partner, first ask yourself: **"Who can compensate for my weaknesses?"**

A Critical Warning

No matter how well-balanced the partners' skills are, if responsibilities and decision-making powers are not clearly defined from the start, the business is **100% guaranteed** to run into trouble.

It is vital to establish—not just through verbal promises, but through a solid **Written Agreement**:

- "Who is responsible for which department?"
- "Who has the final say on specific types of decisions?"

For a partnership to succeed, having a good partner is necessary, but **"working with precise rules and regulations"** is even more important.

My Takeaway

You’ve hit the nail on the head. In the startup world, we often call this the **"Hacker, Hipster, and Hustler"** trio. If everyone is a "Hustler," no one is actually building the product!

By emphasizing the **Written Agreement** alongside **Complementary Skills**, you're describing a professional foundation rather than just a "friendship project."

In your experience, when friends become partners, what is the hardest "responsibility" to divide on paper? Is it the money, or the power to make the final call?